

“What we know about the global financial crisis is that we don’t know very much.”

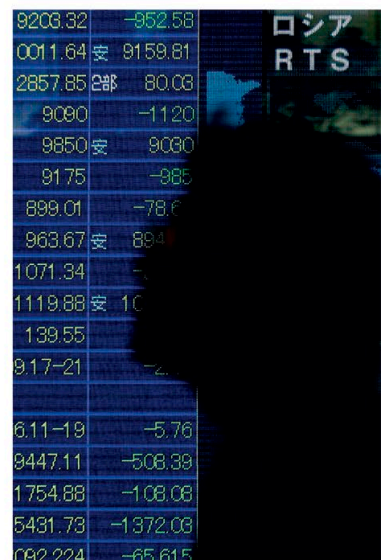
ECONOMIST PAUL SAMUELSON, 2008

25 August 2005 HURRICANE KATRINA

This powerful storm first made landfall in southern Florida, but gathered force as it travelled west across the Gulf of Mexico. When it hit land again in southern Louisiana and Mississippi, it caused massive devastation, particularly in New Orleans, much of which was flooded for weeks. In all, Katrina caused over 1,800 deaths and US\$125 billion of damage.



△ Devastation in the wake of Hurricane Katrina

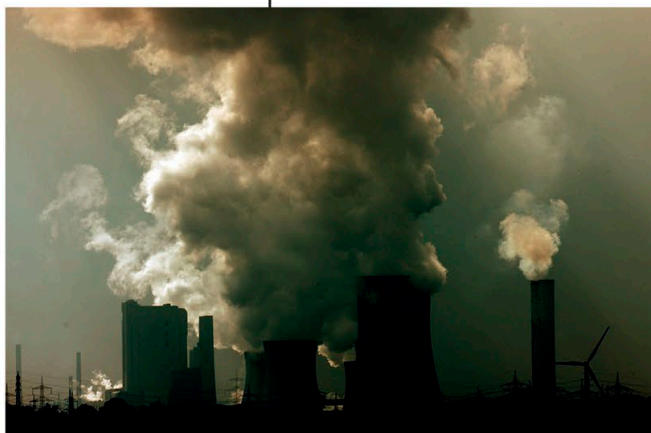


12 July 2006 War breaks out in Lebanon between Israeli forces and Hezbollah paramilitaries

2005

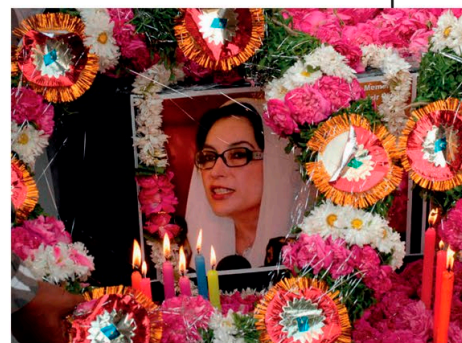
**30 January 2005
Elections are held in Iraq**, but violence continues to trouble the country

▽ A coal-fired power station producing polluting gases and steam



16 February 2005 KYOTO PROTOCOL COMES INTO FORCE

Adopted in 1997 and signed initially by 84 countries, the Protocol entered into force after an agreed percentage of major polluters had signed up to its terms. The accord commits signatories to accept agreed targets for reducing greenhouse gas emissions. Currently 192 parties have put their name to it.



△ Mourning wreaths for Benazir Bhutto

27 December 2007 BENAZIR BHUTTO ASSASSINATED

Benazir Bhutto served two terms as prime minister of Pakistan (in 1988-90 and 1993-96) before being driven from office on corruption charges. After nine years in exile, she returned to Pakistan to stand in a general election, but was killed when leaving a political rally. It is uncertain who was responsible for the attack, but in Pakistan itself, the former President Musharraf, then in exile, was indicted for the murder.